

Daily Herald

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THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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The Daily Herald was first published as a newssheet by the London print unions during their 1911 strike and 66 issues were published between January and April. The initial success and a sale of around 25,000 copies encouraged the printers to broaden their coverage to include general as well as strike news.

Although the newssheet closed, its leaders committed to its relaunch as a permanent newspaper once sufficient funds had been raised. They were joined by dockers' leader Ben Tillett and the Labour MP George Lansbury. They appealed for £10,000, but when the Daily Herald launched on 15 April 1912 it had a working capital of £300.

Its first decade was its most radical. The major struggle in the Labour movement at the time was between those who believed in Parliamentary socialism and those who believed that industrial action was more likely to deliver the reforms they sought. The Daily Herald was to play a crucial role in this conflict. It was also a fervent advocate of female suffrage.

The Daily Herald became a weekly publication during the First World War. It became the main forum for anti-war opinion in the country and was a strong supporter of the Russian Revolution. Its circulation rose to over 250,000. Increased sales meant increased production costs. These were not offset by advertising revenue as its readership profile meant the paper struggled to attract advertisers.

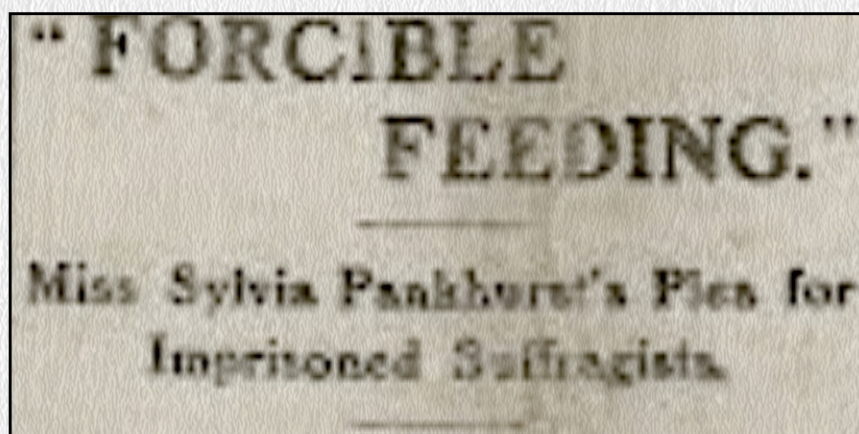
In 1919 the paper reverted to daily publication and now had a circulation of 330,000. Its survival had been a triumph of enthusiasm over financial logic, leading Lord Northcliffe to call it "the Miracle of Fleet Street". Its unprofitability meant it was not in a position to compete in the circulation war of the 1920s and 1930s which featured free insurance schemes for readers and a wealth of free gifts and special offers. By 1922 Lansbury was faced

with closure or persuading the official Labour movement to take it over which the party and the Trades Union Congress agreed to. While this brought initial stability, the paper was not able to profit financially. In 1928 the TUC took full ownership and the following year went into a commercial partnership with Odhams Press.

This allowed the Daily Herald to compete on a level playing field and in mid-1933 it became the first daily newspaper in the world to record a circulation of over two million, beating the Daily Express by a few days. However its official ties, lack of advertising revenue and the change in the Daily Mirror from a middle-class paper to one aimed at a mass working class readership curtailed its ability to grow. By the time it reached its peak circulation of 2.1 million in 1947, the

Daily Mirror and Daily Express were nearing 4 million.

By 1961 the paper was in serious difficulties and was sold to Mirror Group. Three years later International Publishing Corporation acquired the title, ceasing its publication on 14 September 1964 and launching a new paper called The Sun in its place, aimed at the affluent young and the graduates and technocrats coming out of the new universities and technology colleges.



"The amelioration of prison conditions granted under Rule 243a," says Miss Pankhurst, "was extended to the women Suffragists in every case, except that of the women arrested last March. Even the 19 women sentenced at the Newington Sessions so lately as last November were allowed these ameliorations, though they also were convicted for breaking windows the cost of which exceeded £5. The women at present in prison are refused any amelioration whatsoever. They are being treated exactly like the ordinary common criminal." Miss Pankhurst adds that prominent members of the medical profession have declared that the operation of forcible feeding is attended with the greatest risks, and she calls upon the public to protest against the practice.

QUESTION IN THE HOUSE.

Mr. G. Lansbury will to-day ask the Home Secretary a series of questions relating to the sentences passed on Suffragists for window-